



SPACEX
SPATIAL INTELLIGENCE

STEREO IMAGING, TUNED BY EAR

DEPTH WITHOUT REVERB.

Six stages, the Smart dice, a real L / C / R split. Wider, deeper, fuller - and still exactly where the song needs it.

VERSION 1.0.1

VST3

LOW CPU

ZERO LATENCY WITHOUT LCR

SPACE IS THE LAST FREE ROOM IN YOUR MIX.

Depth, fullness and dimension - without a single millisecond of reverb tail. No wash, no mud, nothing you have to EQ back out afterwards.

SpaceX gives a sound its own place in a mix that is already full. Wider, deeper, more three-dimensional - and still standing exactly where the song needs it.

On the surface it is six sections, the Smart dice and a handful of knobs. Underneath it listens to the centre, the sides and everything in between, and keeps every move inside the range where it still sounds like a record. You get to the result fast. You do not get lost on the way.

Most stereo tools are built to be safe. This one is built to be interesting - and then made safe by ear, one decision at a time.

FAST

One click to a finished sound. Smart profiles for lead vocals, backings, adlibs and send FX.

LIGHT

Low CPU. Zero latency - unless you arm the LCR engine. Then you pay a little for the real thing.

CLEAN

A next-generation L / C / R split instead of plain mid-side. Centre, left and right, for real.

SAFE

Hand-tuned and interlocked. Everything the dice can reach was tuned by ear, so it will not hand you a result you have to undo.

WHO BUILT THIS

I have been mixing professionally since 2019 - producer, mix and mastering engineer, on records and for television, among them The Voice. Alongside that I rebuild and optimise recording and mixing templates for other engineers, Jeff Ellis and Mosty among them. Sitting inside someone else's session is the fastest way to see where the real decisions are.

Two terms from Jeff Ellis' Mixer Brain course stuck with me, because they put a name on something I had been doing for years: the forbidden zone and the fourth dimension. When every frequency in a mix is taken, width and depth are the only room left. SpaceX lives in that room.

ONE PLUGIN. UP TO FIVE JOBS.

01	L / C / R extraction	instead of a dedicated centre-separation plugin
02	Micro pitch and Haas doubling	instead of a pitch / delay widener
03	Polarity, side gain, width, mid-side	instead of a utility plugin
04	EQ on the sides only	instead of a mid-side EQ
05	Autopan and stereo phaser	instead of a modulation plugin
06	Goniometer and correlation	instead of a metering plugin

I own every one of those tools. Together they cost well over \$500 and eat five slots. SpaceX does it in one window, with one preset and one latency.

BUILT FOR VOCALS. GREAT ON EVERYTHING ELSE.

WHERE IT BELONGS

LEAD VOCALS

Width around a centre that does not move.

BACKINGS

Stacks, busses and doubles - wide, but tidy.

ADLIBS

Space, movement, clear sides.

SEND FX

Reverb and delay returns. Pure effect, nothing dry.

DRUMS

Kick realism, hats to the sides, room without reverb.

MUSIC

Keys, pads, synths, whole music busses.

BASS

Fatness and stereo - with a low end that stays put.

PRESETS

Sorted in folders, from vocals to drums.

RULE OF THUMB

Rule of thumb: the more room already sits in front of SpaceX, the further you can push it. Last in the chain is the usual spot. It is not a mastering EQ in disguise - on the master bus only if you know exactly why.

THE ONE-MINUTE TOUR.



- | | |
|---|---|
| <p>1 LOGO
Click it for the back panel - who built this, which copy it is.</p> <p>3 POWER · SMART DICE · LIFE · MOD
Bypass, roll, how much it moves, modulation on / off.</p> <p>5 PRESETS
Arrows, list, save.</p> <p>7 SETTINGS · RESET
Themes, behaviour, back to Default.</p> <p>9 STARFIELD
Goniometer and correlation - it reacts to everything.</p> <p>11 SECTIONS
Six stages, top-left to bottom-right.</p> | <p>2 SMART PROFILE
What you are working on. Guides the dice.</p> <p>4 LCR
Arms the L / C / R engine.</p> <p>6 UNDO · A / B
Undo / Redo, compare two settings, copy across.</p> <p>8 INFO LINE
Your Smart profile in one sentence.</p> <p>10 OUTPUT
Meters, Mono, Dry, Mix, Pan, Vol, AG.</p> |
|---|---|

FIRST RESULT IN ONE MINUTE

- 1 Put it on a backing bus, an adlib or an effect return.
- 2 Click the profile until it names your source - Lead Vocal, Backings, Adlibs or Send FX.
- 3 Hit the Smart dice. Listen. Hit it again, until something surprises you.
- 4 Too much? Pull Mix down. Still too much? Click a section name to switch it off.
- 5 Check Mono in the output. If it falls apart, bring Width down a little.

That is the whole workflow. The knobs are there for when you already know what you want.

THE SMART ENGINE.

Tell it what you are working on. Roll the Smart dice. Everything else is taste.



SMART PROFILE

NO PROFILE	The dice may reach for anything.
LEAD VOCAL	Wide, centre stays put.
BACKINGS	Stacks, busses and mono doubles - wide, but tidy.
ADLIBS	Space, movement, clear sides.
SEND FX	Reverb and delay returns - pure effect, nothing dry.

Click for the next one, Cmd-click for the previous one, or hit a dot to jump straight there. The line above the starfield says what the profile does.



POWER	Bypass for the whole plugin. While bypassed it is the only thing that glows - and it breathes, so you never forget.
SMART DICE	Rolls a complete setting and decides which sections belong in it. The face shows how many sections are active.
LIFE	How much everything moves. One knob for every modulation depth. At zero, nothing moves.
MOD	All modulation off - without losing the depths. Switch it back on and it is all still there.
LCR	Arms the L / C / R engine. Needs an analysis window, so it adds latency while it runs.

THE DICE KNOWS WHAT IS ON

Each face is the number of active sections - Polarity, Micropitch, Mid-Side, Autopan, Phaser, and the LCR Matrix while its engine is armed. Click it and it rolls for a moment before it lands.

NOT A RANDOMISER

This is not the randomise button other plugins have. Everything the dice can reach was tuned by ear, and whatever did not work never made it in. Sections you lock with the padlock are left alone. While a section is soloed the dice waits.

THE SIGNAL PATH.



Left to right, top to bottom - the way you read it is the way the audio travels. Latency is zero unless the LCR engine is armed. It needs 4096 samples to find the centre - about 85 ms at 48 kHz, reported to your DAW and compensated.

ON EVERY SECTION

Six sections, one set of rules.

CLICK THE NAME	section on / off. An off section goes dark.
CMD-CLICK THE NAME	solo - hear this section on its own.
CMD + SHIFT-CLICK	reset this section to its defaults.
PADLOCK	the dice leaves this section alone.
DOUBLE-CLICK A KNOB	back to its default.

MID-SIDE VS. L / C / R

Mid-side is not L / C / R. Mid-side splits a stereo signal into sum and difference - everything that is not identical on both sides lands in the sides, including half of what you hear as centre. The LCR Matrix finds what really sits in the middle and keeps hard left and hard right as their own parts. That is why it can open a stack without touching the lead.



Backings profile: sections the dice left out go dark - you always see what the roll actually did.

LCR MATRIX



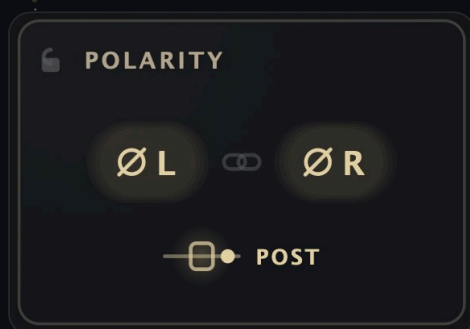
Pulls the centre out of the stereo image and treats left, centre and right as three parts. It only runs while the engine is armed - the LCR button in the header.

L / R	level of the left and right parts. All the way down leaves the centre only.
C-WEIGHT	how strongly the centre is separated from the sides.
HF REGAIN	brings back the highs the split takes away. 0 = off.
EQ → LCR	the Sides EQ works on centre and sides of the LCR Matrix instead of mid and side.

TIP

On a backing stack, push L / R up. The lead keeps the centre, the backings open up around it - without getting louder.

POLARITY



Flips the phase of one channel. The most drastic thing in the plugin - and the one that makes the biggest difference.

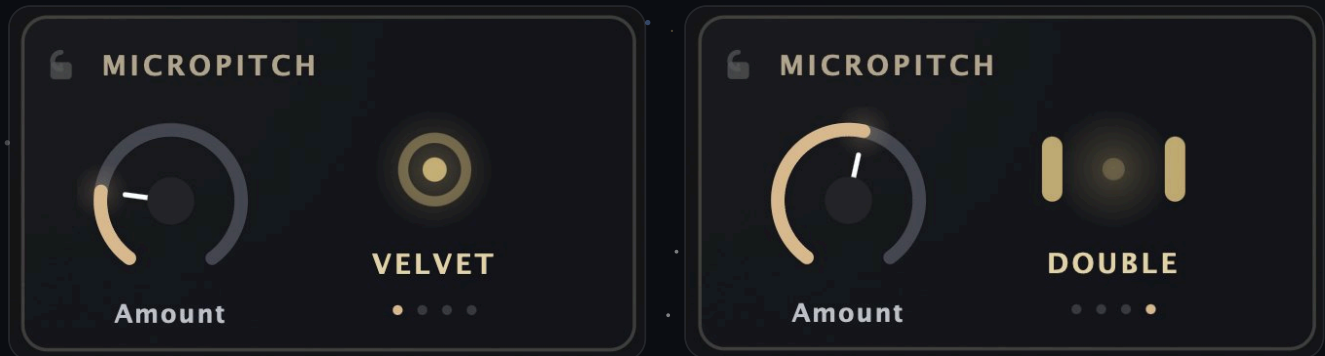
Ø L · Ø R	flip the phase of the left or the right channel. Cmd-click: only that one.
LINK	switch both together.
PRE / POST	flip before Micropitch and Mid-Side, or after them. Two different sounds - try both.

MONO

A flip almost always costs mono. On a throw or an effect return that is fine - nobody expects those to survive a mono sum. On anything that carries the song, check Mono first.

MICROPITCH

Makes a mono sound wide with tiny offsets in time and pitch. One knob, one decision: pick a style, set Amount.



- AMOUNT** how much of the style - from off to full.
- VELVET** the gentlest. Soft and close, the centre barely moves.
- HALO** a soft ring around the sound. Stays centred, holds up in a full mix.
- ILLUSION** sounds wider than it is, but stays tight.
- DOUBLE** the widest of the four, with the strongest character.

MID-SIDE

Width, side level and an EQ that only touches the sides. Reach for it when it is nearly right and just needs to open up.



- WIDTH** how far the image reaches. Below 100 % narrower, above wider.
- SIDES** level of the sides. The centre stays exactly as it is.
- SIDES EQ** Flat, Tight (cleans the lows), Clear (clean plus air), Focus (calmer, brighter centre).
- EQ AMOUNT** the small fader in the header. Left is gentle and the default, right is the strongest.

TIP

Tight on anything with low end. The sides stay open, the bass stays in the middle where mono needs it.

AUTOPAN



Slow automatic movement through the stereo field. Not a tremolo - the level stays put, only the position moves.

AMOUNT	how far the sound travels left and right.
SHAPE	sine, or a smoother pulse-like movement.
SPEED	how fast it moves. Locked while synced.
SYNC	the note: lock the speed to the song tempo.
RATE	note length of one movement - 1/16 up to 8 bars.

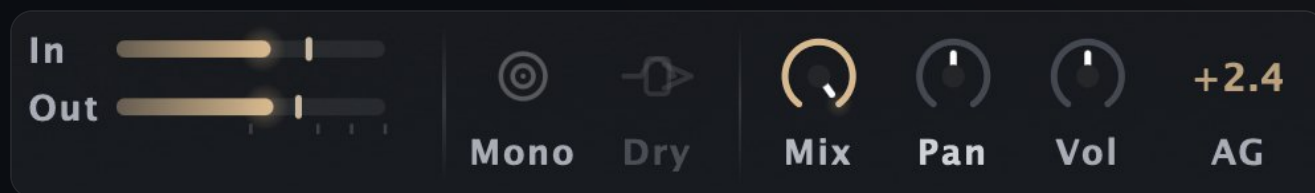
PHASER



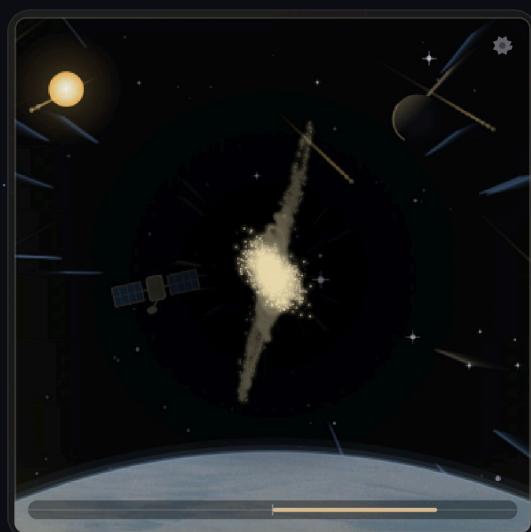
A phaser that moves the image rather than the tone. Subtle on purpose - movement, not an effect you could name.

AMOUNT	how strong it is. At zero it is silent.
SWEEP	the classic slow sweep, low and wide.
SHIMMER	high and quick - air rather than body.
SPIN	low, fast and thick. The obvious one.
SWIRL	very slow and broad. You notice it after a while.
FAST	runs the character a bit quicker.
LINK	follows Autopan at half its speed.

OUTPUT



IN / OUT	input and output level.
MONO	listen to the result in mono.
DRY	while in mono, compare with the unprocessed input.
MIX	blend original and processed. Right-click locks it against presets, A / B, Reset and the dice.
PAN	balance at the very end.
VOL	output, plus or minus 6 dB. Right-click locks it against presets and Reset.
AG	auto gain - matches output to input, so bypass is an honest comparison.



THE STARFIELD

It is not decoration only. The scene reacts to what the plugin is actually doing - the planets, the lines, the way the field leans with the movement.

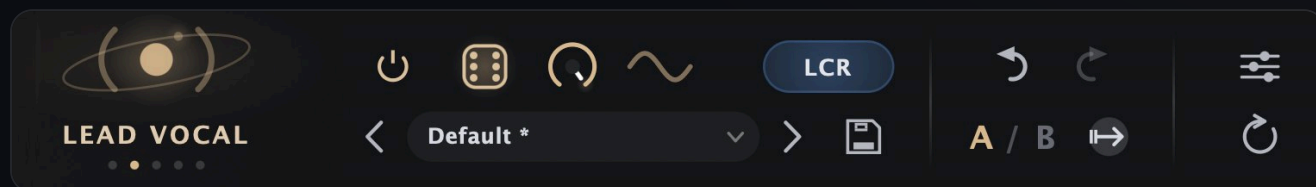
CLICK	scope on / off - a classic goniometer. A vertical line is mono, a circle is wide.
CMD-CLICK THE CENTRE	change the trace colour.
SHIFT-CLICK	change the look.
GEAR	display settings for the starfield.
THE BAR	correlation. Right of centre is mono-safe, left of it cancels.

i Lead vocal - wide, centre stays put.

The '?' at the bottom left switches the info line on. Hover anything and it tells you what it is - the name in your theme colour, and only the commands you could not guess, lightly highlighted.

PRESETS.

Smart categories first, then instrument folders, then your own. Every preset was set by ear on real sessions - start there, then make it yours.



⏮ ⏭	step through the presets of the current folder.
NAME	opens the list. The folder of the loaded preset opens by itself.
* AFTER THE NAME	you changed something since loading.
SAVE	name it, pick a folder - or New Folder right in the list. Open Preset Folder takes you there in Finder.
IN THE LIST	Rename, Delete, Preset Folder - and Default, the clean start.
A / B	two settings side by side. The arrow copies the active side to the other one.
UNDO / REDO	works on everything, the dice included.
RESET	back to the Default preset.

Factory presets are copied into Documents / SpaceX / Presets. SpaceX never overwrites a file that is already there - your edits stay yours.

SETTINGS.

The icon with the three sliders, top right. Changes apply live. Save keeps them, Cancel takes them back, Reset returns to the factory settings.

THEME	Day & Night, Fairy Tale, Science Fiction. None of it changes the sound.
LCR ON STARTUP	the engine is armed when the plugin opens - latency from the start.
SHOW MODULATION	the moving dots on the knobs that show what the modulation is doing.
SAVE STATE AS DEFAULT	every new instance starts with the settings you have right now.
TAKE THE TOUR	a short guided walk through the plugin.
MANUAL	opens this manual.
BACK PANEL	about this copy - and where your serial goes.

DEMO AND ACTIVATION

Without a serial SpaceX runs as a demo. Everything works, but about every 50 seconds the sound goes quiet for a moment. The DEMO badge next to the logo lights up while that happens - never a mystery.

Activation asks for your name and your serial. The two belong together: type the name exactly as it appears in your order - upper and lower case and spaces do not matter. Your name then sits on the back panel under Registered to.

SIX SETTINGS THAT WORK.

Load the preset, or build it by hand - both roads end in the same place.

BACKING STACK THAT WILL NOT FIT

Start from · Backings / Wide But Clean BGVs

Arm LCR, push L / R up, Width around 140 %, Sides EQ on Focus. The lead keeps the centre, the stack takes everything around it.

DELAY THROW WITH AN IDENTITY

Start from · Send FX / Forbidden Echo Zone

Micropitch on Illusion, Amount around 60 %, Phaser on Sweep at a third. The throw stops sounding like a delay and starts sounding like a decision.

REVERB RETURN WITH DEPTH, NO MUD

Start from · Send FX / Tight Reverb

Width around 130 %, Sides a touch up, Sides EQ on Tight. The reverb moves behind the dry signal instead of sitting on top of it.

ADLIBS THAT APPEAR AND DISAPPEAR

Start from · Adlibs / Adlib Drift

Autopan Amount around 40 %, Sync on, 4 bars. Slow enough that nobody notices the movement, fast enough that the part never sits still.

BASS WITH WIDTH AND A SOLID MIDDLE

Start from · Bass / Mono 2 Stereo Bass

Micropitch on Velvet, a little Amount, Sides EQ on Tight. Stereo on top, mono where the club system needs it.

THE FORBIDDEN ONE

Start from · your throw track

ØL on, PRE, Mix around 60 %. Mono will not survive it. On a throw in a dense chorus it is the widest thing you own.

The more room already sits in front of SpaceX, the further you can push it.

CLICKS WORTH KNOWING.

The basics you will guess. These you will not.

Double-click a knob	back to default
Click a section name	section on / off
Cmd-click a section name	solo
Cmd + Shift-click a section name	reset that section
Click a style · Cmd-click	next · previous. The dots jump straight there
Cmd-click ØL / ØR	flip only that side
Right-click Mix / Vol	lock against presets and Reset
Click the starfield	scope on / off
Cmd-click · Shift-click starfield	trace colour · look
Click the logo	back panel
?	info line on / off

TAKE THE TOUR

A short guided walk through every section. In the settings - and on first launch.

INFO LINE

The ? at the bottom left. Hover anything and it says what it is.

BACK PANEL

Click the logo. Who built this, how to reach him, which copy this is.

MADE BY LISTENING.

SpaceX started as a way to stop opening five plugins for one idea. Nothing in it happened by accident: the order of the chain, where the polarity flip may sit, how far each section is allowed to go. Every one of those decisions was made by listening - and then made again.

Thanks to Jeff Ellis, whose words for the forbidden zone and the fourth dimension gave the idea a name. And to everyone who tested SpaceX and sent feedback - a lot of what is good in the details came from you.



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